Prismatic Compass



Category: **Measuring & Marking Tools** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Prismatic and Surveyor compass

What it is used for

A prismatic compass measures magnetic bearings for basic surveying and field orientation. Set it up away from magnetic interference and record bearings using the required survey procedure.

How to use

1. Inspect the compass, prism, sighting system, needle, and protective cover.
2. Choose a stable observation point away from vehicles, steel structures, and electrical equipment.
3. Hold or mount the compass level according to its design.
4. Release the needle lock and allow the magnetic needle to settle.
5. Sight the target through the designated sighting system and read the bearing.
6. Record the bearing, station, and relevant field conditions in the survey notes.
7. Lock the needle if provided and protect the compass after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep clear of traffic, unstable ground, and exposed edges during surveying.
- Avoid magnetic objects and electrical equipment that may distort readings.
- Do not use a damaged compass for critical measurements.
- Follow site rules when working near roads or construction areas.

Care & storage

- Clean optical surfaces gently and store the compass in its protective case.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.